

There was a tie between two monitors—the Compaq MV7500 and the BenQ G774; both scoring 4.25 points in the Screen pixel resolution tests. The LG E700S came a very close second, scoring 4 points. The NEC Multi Sync 75 showed poor performance here again—a lot of jaggedness, as well as merged pixels near the intersection of two lines were noticed.

In the 19-inch category, LG Studioworks breezed through the test, scoring a perfect 5. BenQ V991 came very close by scoring 4.5, while NEC MultiSync 95 and Samsung SyncMaster 955DF both stood last, but scored a respectable 4.25 points.

For the Colour tests, the 17-inch Compaq MV 7500 was a clear winner as it breezed remarkably through all the tests, including ghosting and streaking. LG Studio Works 700S came second with a good performance in most tests—except for its average performance in the colour streaking one. The Microtek 43F1 had a below average performance—we could distinctly notice the streaking and ghosting, and the colour red was not uniform in the colour purity test.

Moving on to the 19-inch category, BenQ V991 emerged as the winner because we could barely make out any sort of streaking and ghosting. The LG Studioworks 900B lost the race only due to slight ghosting and streaking. NEC AccuSync 95 F was the only monitor which did not perform well. It displayed streaking and ghosting, and logged an average score in the colour purity test.

In the Miscellaneous Effects test, the LG Studio Works 700S won in the 17-inch category by scoring 19.75. The BenQ G774 stood second with a respectable score of 18.5, and the Compaq MV 7500 came very close with 18 points.

Compaq lost because of its extremely poor performance in the dark screen test, whereas the BenQ lost because of its aver-

age performance in the Screen Uniformity test. The HCL HCM 780 stood last as it performed badly in the trio of Dark Screen, Screen Uniformity and Defocus Blooming halos tests.

In the 19-inches category, BenQ V991 was the top performer and scored an astounding 17.5. Except in the Dark Screen test, it performed brilliantly in all the tests. The Samsung SyncMaster 955DF came in second, with a score of 16.75 points. It lost out due to its average performance in the CRT Shadow Mask Distortion test. The LG Studio Works 900B came last owing to its below average performance in the Screen Uniformity, Defocus Blooming and Halos tests.

The clear picture

It was a well-fought out battle between the brands dominating the Indian scenario, with a proper photo-finish race.

The 17-inches category saw the maximum number of monitors—a total of 10 monitors, representing seven different brands. The winner was undoubtedly, the Compaq MV 7500, costing Rs 13, 500, which puts it out of reach for home users, but within the scope of professionals. The best monitor in the price-performance slot was the LG Studioworks 700S. This monitor costs only Rs 7,450—its low price and admirable performance make it the preferred choice of users across the board—be it the home user, the office user or even gamer.

The 19-inches category crowned the BenQ V991, which scored 38.9 in the performance test as the fitting winner. This monitor produced impressive results in all the tests in our evaluation. The BenQ V991 is best suited for graphic applications, multimedia authoring and other high end 3D applications. It also won the best value award because of its extremely competitive price of Rs 12,999.

Test your Own Monitor

It's a great feeling to have a new monitor on your desk. However, to get a near perfect display, use an excellent utility called DisplayMate. To calibrate the monitor, you can tweak the following settings:

Brightness and contrast adjustment: Calibrating brightness and contrast for the monitor is very important for proper colour reproduction and details. DisplayMate offers a screen with text written in dark grey, grey and white. You need to calibrate the monitor till this text is clearly visible.

Screen framing and aspect ratio: This screen presents you with the rectangle and circle which is needed to be wrapped perfectly to the raster. After the wrapping is done, check out for the parallelism of the lines with respect to the monitors frame. In most monitors it will be tilted on one of the sides. Use the geometry controls tilt and rotate to correct this. This may be time-consuming, but its very important for optimal viewing.

Circular test pattern: This setting displays a set of concentric circles in the middle and the four corners of the screen. All you have to do is pick up the deformed circles, and correct the problem using the Pincushion or Pinbalance function in OSD.

Resolution: Because the resolution of the monitor is not necessarily the same as the resolution provided by graphics card, there is a loss in details. This screen displays tightly spaced bars at full resolution. If there is a visible loss of details or moiré pattern, try reducing the refresh rate. Also try to increase screen horizontally if possible, and decrease the contrast a bit.

Colour scales: This screen has 10 colours displaying 25 intensity levels. Ideally, the intensity of each level should increase as you move from light to dark region. If not, try changing the Colour Temperature to one of the two settings, i.e., 9300K and 6500K. Some monitors also have the user settings where you can set the RGB levels independently.

Screen Regulation: This test flashes a very bright screen. The screen size increases when bright and contracts when it dims. To reduce this problem, try decreasing the contrast to a level where the size variation is not substantial and screen is not dark enough to read a document on it.



Benq V991

+ High refresh rates;
very good performance
- Low on features

LG Studioworks 900B

+ Support for highest
video bandwidth
- Poor performance in
Screen Uniformity test

NEC Multisync 95

+ High refresh rates
- Semi-tint coating;
expensive

Samsung Syncmaster
955DF

+ F&FST
- Low refresh rate; Heavy